

Talking Points for Shopkeepers & Staff

For anyone who gets asked about the Future Together event poster.

These talking points are for you and your staff. If a customer asks about the poster, this covers the most common questions. Feel free to let them read it — or point them to futuretogether.community/meetups for the full details.

What is it about?

It's a free community talk about how technology changes are affecting jobs, businesses and everyday life — and what our community can do about it. Think of it less like a tech talk and more like a community conversation about our future. The topics are specific to Tumbarumba's situation: farming, the rail trail, small business, forestry, and what it all means for our kids.

I see 'AI' on the big poster — is this a tech event?

AI is part of it, but the talk isn't about using AI or whether you like it. It's about changes that are already happening — to jobs, to how businesses work, to what skills young people will need — whether people use technology or not. When people hear 'AI', many immediately say 'I don't use AI' and switch off. But you don't need to use or understand technology to be affected by it.

Is it really free? Do I need to register?

Free. No registration required — just turn up. Doors open at 6pm, talk starts at 6:30pm at Café Nest Cinema. If you'd like to reserve a seat, you can at futuretogether.community/meetups — but the door will be open regardless.

Who's running it?

Charlie Garrison, with the support of the Tumbarumba Chamber of Commerce. Charlie started Future Together to help communities understand what's changing and how to respond — not with panic or paralysis, but with honest information and practical action. Several Chamber members are planning to attend.

What will actually be covered?

- How fast things are changing — and why the pace matters
- Why getting AI to reliably do what humanity wants — not just what we ask — turns out to be unsolved, and why that's not a small thing
- What changes when AI starts designing smarter AI — and why that threshold, once crossed, affects everyone
- What it means for work and local business in regional areas
- Why rural communities like Tumbarumba have real strengths here
- What a genuinely good future looks like — honest hope, not wishful thinking
- Six practical things people can do right now

What about my kids?

Probably the most important question. High school students are the generation most directly affected by what's coming — in terms of jobs, skills, and the world they'll inherit. The talk is as much for parents who want to understand what their kids are heading into as it is for anyone else.

Will there be another one if I miss it?

If there's enough interest, yes. And there's already a smaller ongoing gathering — the Future Together coffee chat, every Tuesday morning at 8am here at Café Nest. Informal, open to anyone who's curious. No agenda, no jargon — just conversation.

Even the Pope is talking about this?

He is. Pope Leo recently released '*Magnifica Humanitas — On Safeguarding The Human Person In The Time Of Artificial Intelligence*'. This conversation is happening at every level of society — from the Vatican to Tumbarumba. It belongs to everyone.